BILLBOARD TOP 10

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The "My plan" column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students' hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Explore Billboard Top 10, complete the Top 10 analysis. Begin song form analysis.	Slides 1–6: hook, listen to the No. 1, what emulation is, the seven classes, the Top 10 and song form. Hand out the project sheet and the Top 10 analysis.	Slides 1–6	p. 11, p. 14, p. 15, p. 16, p. 18
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Finish song form mapping. Analyze drum patterns and begin programming in Logic.	Slides 7–10: a mapped song, tempo and markers demo, the drums broken down, drum demo. Check every Song Form map before students open Logic.	Slides 7–10	p. 12, p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — build tracks, layer instruments, refine arrangement.	Slide 11: build your foundation (bass, chords, core instruments). Then work time; circulate.	Slide 11	—
CLASS 4		Slide 12: add layers (melodies, pads, FX, transitions). Then work time.	Slide 12	—
CLASS 5		Full working day: refine the arrangement against the original, section by section.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix and bounce. Prepare presentations and write 3 Padlet feedback questions.	Slides 13–15: mix and refine, what you turn in, the rubric. Students self-score, bounce and post their questions.	Slides 13–15	p. 17, p. 19
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 16–17: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate's questions.	Slides 16–17	p. 19

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 2

From my common struggles: students skip counting bars. Require the Song Form map (page 12) before they open Logic. Slides 7 and 8 model it.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days. Slides 11 and 12 open Classes 3 and 4; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate with each student's Song Form map and ask: which section are you building, and does it match the original's energy?

PREVIEW

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BILLBOARD TOP 10

Song Form map

STUDENT

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Song: _____ **Artist:** _____

Beats in 15 seconds: _____ **× 4 = Tempo (BPM):** _____ **Checked with the metronome?** _____

Listen with headphones and count the bars: 1, 2, 3, 4, then say the bar number on every 1. Write each section in order (intro, verse, pre-chorus, chorus, bridge, outro…).

#	SECTION	STARTS AT (M:SS)	BARS	WHAT'S HAPPENING (INSTRUMENTS, ENERGY, DRUMS)	MARKER IN LOGIC
1					☐
2					☐
3					☐
4					☐
5					☐
6					☐
7					☐
8					☐
9					☐
10					☐
11					☐
12					☐

Total bars: _____ **× (240 ÷ BPM) =** _____ **seconds. The song is** _____ **long. Close?** _____

FINISH THIS BEFORE YOU OPEN LOGIC

Your teacher checks this map in Class 2. Then each row becomes an Arrangement Marker, sized to its bars.

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BILLBOARD TOP 10

Project sheet · requirements and steps

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose one song from the current Billboard Top 10
- ☐ Match the tempo of your chosen song exactly
- ☐ Recreate the exact song form (intro, verse, chorus, bridge, etc.)
- ☐ Drum patterns must be self-created — percussion loops are okay as accents
- ☐ Use appropriate instruments and layers for the genre
- ☐ Apply EQ and plug-ins to shape your sounds authentically

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Explore the Billboard Top 10** — listen to all 10 songs and complete the Top 10 analysis (page 11)
2. **Study song form** — map out the exact structure of your chosen song using the Song Form map (page 12)
3. **Analyze and program drum patterns** — break down the kick, snare, and hi-hat and build them in Logic (page 13). Set up Arrangement Markers.
4. **Build your foundation** — lay down bass, chords, and core instrumentation to match the original's energy
5. **Add layers** — fill in melodies, pads, FX, and transitions to match the fullness of the original
6. **Mix and refine** — EQ every track, pan for width, adjust levels, and add plug-ins for authenticity
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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BILLBOARD TOP 10

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Billboard Top 10 | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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